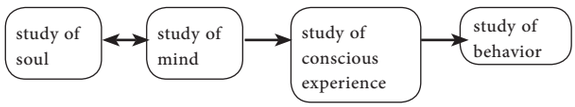
3.3 EVOLUTION OF MEANING OF PSYCHOLOGY

The meaning of psychology has been shifted from study of soul to study of behavior



So, study of human behavior helps nurses to deliver quality care to the patients by adjusting their own behavior. Behavior involves both body and mind.

3.4 IMPORTANCE OF PSYCHOLOGY IN NURSING

The study of human behavior is of great value to a nursing professional in a number of ways.

Psychology has become necessary in every profession including nursing today. This is because of increasing emphasis being laid out on the interplay of body, mind and spirit in the health status of every individual. The learning of psychology helps a nurse in the following ways.

1. **To understand own self**- The knowledge of psychology will help the nurse to get insight in to her own motives, desires, emotions, feelings, attitudes. This knowledge also helps her to understand her strength and weakness.
2. **To understand patients**- Patients may also have tension, worries, pains and also many doubts about their illness. The knowledge of psychology will help the nurse to understand the problems and needs of patients to attend them. She can understand the motives, and attitudes of patients in a better way.
3. **To recognize abnormal behavior**- The knowledge of psychology will help nurses to understand abnormal behaviors and help the patient in management of mental illnesses.
4. **To understand other self**-The student nurse has to study, work, and live with other nurses and doctor, patient and their family members. She will learn why other differ from her in their like and dislike, in their interest and abilities or in their reaction to others.
5. **To provide quality care to patients**- A nurse with good knowledge of human psychology can understand what fears or anxieties the patient faces, what he feels? what he would like to know? and why he behaves the way he does?
6. **Help the patients to adjust the situation**- Illness and physical handicaps often bring about the need for major adjustment. A nurse trained in psychology can be an effective health educator and help in these kind of adjustment.
7. **Help the student nurse** to appreciate the necessity for changing the environment or surrounding. The change in the environment is sometimes necessary for better adjustment and happiness.
8. **Helps for Readjustment**
   1. Nursing profession requires readjustment for success in the nursing carrier-: overcoming homesickness and self-reliance is needed if she has to live smoothly in a hostel or a hospital.

Nursing-voc_Unit 03.indd 54 22-02-2019 4.44.13 PM